Two ways of isolating: both give the same result

Method 1: the same on BOTH sides

Do the **opposite operation** on both sides of the equation.

it is adding (+ 3)	→	subtract 3 on both sides
it is subtracting (− 3)	→	add 3 on both sides
it is multiplying (· 3)	→	divide both sides by 3
it is dividing (/ 3)	→	multiply both sides by 3

$$x + 3 = 7$$
$$x + 3 - 3 = 7 - 3$$
$$x = 4$$

Method 2: it “goes to the other side”

It changes side and does the **opposite operation**.

adding	⇄	goes subtracting
subtracting	⇄	goes adding
multiplying	⇄	goes dividing
dividing	⇄	goes multiplying

$$x + 3 = 7$$
$$x = 7 - 3$$
$$x = 4$$